The teacher was annoyed. This time she called her name louder, "Nandhini!" and then, she raised her hand but did not answer. The teacher went near Nandhini. She touched her forehead and asked, "Are you feeling okay?" Nandhini shook her head. Her cheeks were red, and it looked like she had a fever. "Do you have a fever? Shall I call your parents?" asked the teacher. She shook her head, but she still did not look at anyone. Her head was still bowed down.



"Why does Nandhini look so sad?" exclaimed her friends. Her friends pestered her with a hundred questions! The questions were about everything that you think about. They asked her family, her house, her shoes and even about her street pets. Each question that she was asked, Nandhini only answered by shaking her head.

Pandi had enough of Nandhini's silence. He had never seen her so dull. He wanted an idea to make her smile. He thought, thought and thought for many hours. Finally, he had an idea! He took out something from his bag and ran to show it to her. He tumbled, and it slipped from his hands. It was flying straight to Nandhini. She saw something flying towards her and screamed with fear. She closed her eyes and tried to catch it. THUD! She caught it. It was a big green frog. Everyone ran away as they were scared of the frog.



Guess the reason for her sadness.





Nandhini's eyes were wide open with surprise. Then, she burst into laughter. It was a rubber frog! As soon as she laughed, her friends and teacher knew why she did not smile or talk to anyone all day. Two of her front teeth were missing!

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